CAA UK 2026 · Glasgow · Poster

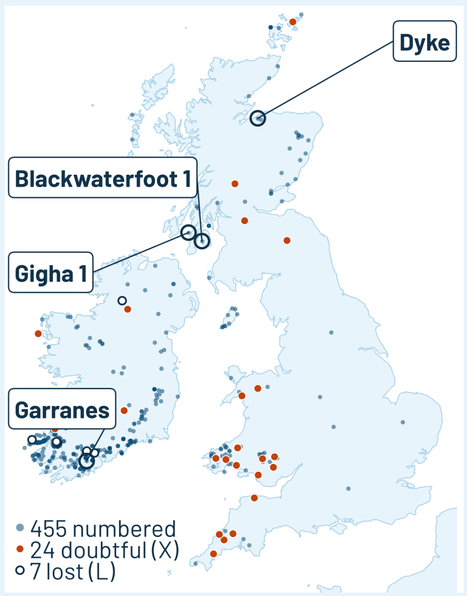
Purported, Alleged, Undetermined

Four Degrees of Doubt in the Ogham Corpus

Florian Thiery[1]

[1] Research Squirrel Engineers Network

The corpus



Doubt is written, then lost

Editions mark doubt with care: what is unclear, restored or lost, and where editors disagree. In a knowledge graph that care often vanishes, and a hesitant reading looks like a confident one.

One pipeline, two axes

Two open Python pipelines read the same TEI/EpiDoc editions of OG(H)AM. **Axis 1** maps their structure to CIDOC CRM; **axis 2** turns every reading into a weighted statement.

Fact or editorial history?

34 records marked doubtful

21 of them British

20 stones with no coordinate

The corpus marks 34 records as doubtful, 21 of them British, and 20 stones have no coordinate at all. Do these records reflect a material fact, or the history of who looked at them and how?

A weathered stone is a fact about the object. A reading that nobody can check is a fact about the record. The editions mark both kinds of doubt with care; this poster follows that care from the TEI edition to a weighted statement.

Four degrees of doubt

[A] restored by the editor · **A** unclear · gap, lost · M/A alternative letters · vague (certainty below 1) · uncertain (readers disagree) · both



C[A]SSITT[A]S MAQI MU[CO]I CALLITI — 1.00

RR[M/A]|[O/G]QDITT◇SSS
EDD◇RRNON V THIHAL IRR UIBUZ
SON[S/N]|ELCC◇ — 1.00

MEQ[E/I] — 0.31 | 0.28 | 0.28 | 0.14

DEGREE 1
Garranes
CIIC 81
Three restored letters, otherwise secure. One reading: weight 1.0.

DEGREE 2
Dyke
no CIIC number
12 unclear letters, 9 gaps, 3 pairs of alternatives. Still one reading: weight 1.0.

DEGREE 3
Blackwaterfoot 1
inscription 1
Four competing readings, three with no editor named. The weight is a share between them.



Degree 4: Gigha 1 (CIIC 506), five editors, five readings

Macalister 1902	VICULA MAQ COMGINI	0.2727
Macalister 1945	VICULA MAQ CUGINI	0.2727
OG(H)AM edition (KF)	[—]MAQ[—]COGIN[—]	0.1818
Rhys 1899	MAQICAGILEB	0.1818
Rhys 1901	OGMA MAQI TIGERNI	0.0909

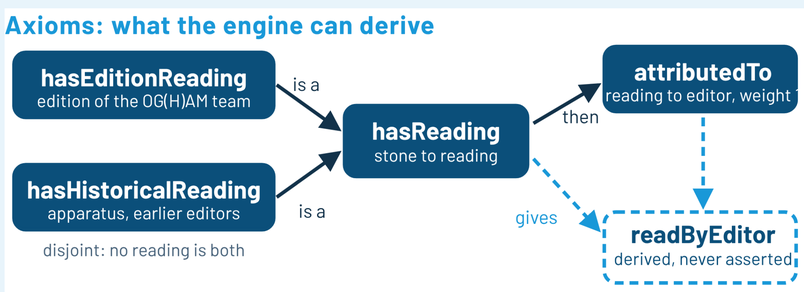
CIDOC CRM + CRMtex (axis 1)

Gigha 1 (E22 object) — carries → Inscription (CRMtex TX1) — identified as → Reading (CRMtex TX7) — attributed to → Editor KF (E21 · PROV-O)

Academic Meta Tool (axis 2)

Gigha 1 hasReading [—]MAQ[—]COGIN[—]
weight **0.1818** · type **fuzziness + wobbliness**

Axioms: what the engine can derive



Derived for Gigha 1

Macalister 1902	0.2727
Macalister 1945	0.2727
OG(H)AM edition (KF)	0.1818
Rhys 1899	0.1818
Rhys 1901	0.0909

0.18 to 0.13
the edition's own reading

0.27 to 0.29
each Macalister reading

A second rule. The edition of Gigha 1 is marked `cert="low"`. Rule v2 reads that mark: the edition's share falls and its rivals gain. Rule v1 ignored it.

Where the method is blind

Blind spot	What the stones show
One reading weighs 1.0	Garranes: three restored letters
Weights are shares	0.18 ranks readings, no probability
Doubt in prose is invisible	*purported*, *alleged* are prose
Anonymous readings	Blackwaterfoot 1: no editor named

Where next

Planned:

- all 34 doubtful records through the same pipeline, to compare the four degrees of doubt across the corpus;
- editors asked to name the three anonymous readings;
- doubt in prose (*purported*) as markup, so that the reasoning can see it.

Explore

People



Florian Thiery

Behind the work

In cooperation with NFDI4 OBJECTS

References

- Unold, M., Thiery, F., & Mees, A. (2019). Academic Meta Tool. *ZfdG*, Sonderband 4. doi:10.17175/SB004_004
- Eide, Ø., et al. (2026). Vagueness, uncertainty and their combination in the Cultural Heritage Domain. doi:10.5281/ZENODO.19877824
- Thiery, F., et al. (2026). From stones and wells to tephra: Leveraging Wikidata and Wikibase for interdisciplinary humanities linked data. *J. Open Humanities Data*, 12(1), 10. doi:10.5334/johd.425
- Kasten, M., & Forsyth, K. (2023). Report on OG(H)AM. *runes:et:al.*, 1. doi:10.17904/ku.edoc.33410
- O'Connor, P., & Guariento, L. (2026). og-h-am. github.com/lguariento/og-h-am